LEARN · GRAMMAR

A2

Will & Going To



Both talk about the future, but they answer different questions: was this decided **just now**, or was it **planned already**?

WHEN WAS IT DECIDED?

NOW

decided right now
no evidence, just an opinion

WILL
The phone's ringing — I'll get it!

decided before now
or evidence you can see now (already arranged)

GOING TO
Those clouds — it's going to rain.

✗ I'm going to help you (deciding right now)
✓ I'll help you

1 Form

will + base verb (short forms: 'll, won't). **am / is / are + going to + base verb**.

- I**'ll help** you. / She **won't come**.
- I**'m going to help** you. / They **aren't going to come**.

2 Use 'will' for…

A decision made at the moment of speaking, a prediction with no real evidence (just an opinion), and promises and offers.

- The phone's ringing — I**'ll get** it!
- I think it**'ll be** sunny tomorrow.
- I**'ll carry** that for you.
- I promise I**'ll call** you.

3 Use 'going to' for…

A plan or intention decided before now, a prediction based on evidence you can see right now, and something already arranged.

- I**'m going to visit** my parents this weekend.
- Look at those clouds — it**'s going to rain**.
- She**'s going to start** a new job next month.

4 Common mistakes

✗ I go to call you tomorrow.	✓ **I'm going to call you tomorrow.**	need 'am/is/are'
✗ Look at the sky, it will rain.	✓ **Look at the sky, it's going to rain.**	visible evidence now
✗ She wills come later.	✓ **She'll come later.**	'will' never takes -s

APPLY · PRACTICE

A2

Will & Going To Practice

A Choose the correct word

1. I think people ___ use more electric cars in the future. **(will / are going to)**
2. Careful! You ___ drop that glass! **(will / are going to)**
3. She has decided: she ___ apply for the job. **(will / is going to)**
4. I promise I ___ be late again. **(won't / am not going to)**
5. I'm hungry. I ___ make a sandwich. **(will / am going to / go)**
6. The sky is completely black — it ___ storm tonight. **(is going to / will / would)**

B Complete with will or going to

1. We ___ visit my grandparents this weekend. We already bought the tickets.
2. 'I forgot my wallet.' 'Don't worry, I ___ pay for lunch.'
3. The score is 5-0. Our team ___ win!
4. He's yawning non-stop — he ___ fall asleep soon.
5. She's saved enough money, so she ___ buy a new car next month.
6. I hope you ___ enjoy the party.

C Find and fix the mistake

1. She will to call you later.
2. They going to move house next month.
3. He is going to buys a new laptop.
4. She wills call you when she arrives.
5. We are going to traveling to Peru next year.
6. Will she to come to the party tonight?

D Make it negative, then a question (going to)

1. she / start / her own business
   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____
2. we / renovate / the kitchen next spring
   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____
3. they / move / house next month
   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____
4. he / buy / a new laptop
   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

E Speak

say it out loud with a partner

1. Describe three plans for next weekend using going to.
2. Make two offers using I'll...
3. Look around the room and make two evidence-based predictions with going to.